

Contact

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(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Legacy Systems

Data Accuracy

Debugging

Certifications

CompTIA Security+

Mark Leigh

Professional Development & Technical Upskilling | CompTIA
Security+ Certified | Crest CPSA ongoing
United Kingdom

Summary

I am a senior data engineer who focuses on improving the integrity, reliability and security of data platforms. Most of my work starts when something isn't quite right – perhaps data can't be trusted, pipelines aren't behaving as expected, or systems risk isn't fully understood. I'm skilled at cutting through the noise to work out what's actually going on beneath the surface, and put in place solutions that make things stable, predictable and safe. My background is in data engineering, but the common thread has always been control, making sure data is accurate, complete and handled properly across production and non-production environments. This has included tightening validation and reconciliation processes, resolving persistent failures, supporting cloud migrations, and enabling the safe use of sensitive data. More recently, my work has naturally moved closer to DevSecOps and cyber-focused practices – not as a separate discipline, but as part of how platforms should be built and run, with security, control and risk considered from the outset rather than added later. I'm comfortable working across both technical and business teams, translating issues into something clear and actionable, and helping move things forward without overcomplicating them. I'm currently building further depth in this area through hands-on application and ongoing study (CompTIA Security+ and CREST CPSA), with a focus on applying security principles in real-world data platform environments.

Specialities: DevSecOps & Secure Platform Engineering ✓
Cloud Security Principles (GCP) ✓ Data Security & Protection
✓ Platform Integrity & Risk Reduction ✓ Data Pipeline Security
✓ Secure Data Processing ✓ Data Validation & Control
Frameworks ✓ Data Integrity & Lineage ✓ Python (Applied)
✓ SQL ✓ SAS (Base, Macro, DI Studio, Enterprise Guide) ✓
Operational Resilience & Reliability ✓ Root Cause Analysis
✓ Incident Resolution & Production Support ✓ Governance,
Risk & Compliance ✓ Audit & Control Implementation ✓
Stakeholder Engagement ✓ Agile / Waterfall / Hybrid Environments

Experience

SWAROVSKI

Senior Data Engineer

March 2020 - January 2024 (3 years 11 months)

Zurich, Switzerland

I was initially appointed as a contract Data Engineer to stabilise a poorly performing, undocumented SAS analytics environment; recognised for impact and transitioned into a permanent role within a newly formed Data Lake team, operating as the most senior engineer across a cross-skilled team.

Led migration of a complex, business-critical legacy SAS analytics platform to Google Cloud Platform, delivered within 9 months, enabling €1m annual cost savings.

Re-engineered data quality and reconciliation processes within a poorly controlled legacy environment, reducing processing time by >50%, eliminating data gaps, and reducing failure rates from c.25% to 2%.

Transformed performance and reliability of data pipelines, reducing batch processing times and enabling more timely and accurate business insight.

Recognised, commended and rewarded for consistent high performance throughout tenure.

Lloyds Banking Group

SAS Consultant - Lead Developer

January 2016 - September 2019 (3 years 9 months)

Halifax

I was engaged as Lead Developer on a regulatory reporting programme (FINREP), acting as the bridge between project management and development teams to deliver a complex, data-driven solution within a regulated banking environment.

Led development of a FINREP regulatory reporting solution to a tight deadline, aligning multiple data domains and ensuring accurate classification of financial exposures, avoiding potential penalties.

Key contributor to a complex Collections and Recoveries migration, applying Agile principles within a Waterfall environment to overcome delivery challenges and ensure successful implementation.

Instrumental in stabilising delivery within a complex team environment, enforcing consistent development approaches and resolving delivery challenges to ensure successful programme completion.

RWE Npower

SAS Consultant

September 2014 - December 2015 (1 year 4 months)

West Midlands

I delivered data solutions within a marketing-focused data services environment, working closely with business stakeholders to define, standardise and deliver consistent, high-quality campaign data.

Designed and delivered data extraction and transformation solutions to support targeted marketing campaigns, ensuring consistent data formats despite variability from external providers.

Secured stakeholder buy-in to improve data quality/consistency, reducing rework.

Mentored team members on SAS Enterprise Guide, strengthening data services team capability.

Lloyds Banking Group

SAS Consultant, MMR

January 2014 - May 2014 (5 months)

Pendeford

Supported delivery of regulatory change under the Mortgage Market Review (MMR), developing and testing data solutions within a controlled banking environment.

RWE Npower

Customer Planning Model Developer

June 2013 - December 2013 (7 months)

Worcester and Kidderminster Area

Lloyds Banking Group

SAS Consultant

September 2012 - April 2013 (8 months)

Pendeford

Capgemini

SAS Consultant

May 2012 - September 2012 (5 months)

Greater Northampton Area, United Kingdom

Barclaycard

SAS Consultant

January 2011 - October 2011 (10 months)

Greater Northampton Area, United Kingdom

CSC Sverige AB

Pro-IV Consultant

October 2010 - December 2010 (3 months)

CSC Sverige AB

Pro-IV Consultant

May 2008 - April 2010 (2 years)

Nationwide Building Society

SAS Consultant

March 2008 - March 2008 (1 month)

Nationwide Building Society

SAS Consultant

June 2007 - December 2007 (7 months)

Royal Bank of Scotland

Senior Systems Analyst

April 2001 - May 2007 (6 years 2 months)

Direct Line

Systems Analyst/Programmer

2001 - 2005 (4 years)

Education

De Montfort University

BSc, Applied Computer Science · (1994 - 1997)

Optima Training & Consultancy Ltd

CompTia Security+ · (February 2026 - May 2026)

Optima Training & Consultancy Ltd

Crest CPSA · (February 2026)

De Montfort University

BTEC HND, Computing · (1992 - 1993)

West Herts College

BTEC National Diploma, Computing · (1992)